

Transitive and Intransitive English Verbs

A Quick Reference Guide

The question is to see how the English language has developed to function in the way that it does, with two words for each "sensation." The main pattern is that more detail is *customary* in spatial descriptions and with private thoughts and feelings. The answer to the question of *why* this added detail is customary may be that these details are practical in these contexts.

What kind of word?	"Intransitive"	"Transitive"	
Is detail optional?	detail is required	details are optional:	
Use of Preposition:	must use a preposition	can be used without a preposition	Sometimes can be used with a preposition
Function of using or not using details.	A: private thoughts and feelings, subtle topics.	Simple, binary (yes or no). (Details not needed.)	Adding optional detail, usually not needed or added.
	B: details of physical space		

Non-Directional Personal & Directional Spatial				
Sense / Category	Word	Directional	Transitive / Intransitive (w/o preposition) / (w/preposition) Binary / detailed	External / Personal
hearing/ vibration	hear	not directional	Transitive	external
	listen (to)	not directional	Intransitive	personal
Learning	Study/Practice	not directional	Transitive	external
	Learn (to)	not directional	Intransitive	personal
Obtain/Want	have / get	not directional	Transitive	external
	want (to)/yearn (to)	not directional	Intransitive	personal
Think	analyze/calculate	not directional	Transitive	external
	think (about)	not directional	Intransitive	personal
light/sight	see	Directional	Transitive	personal
	look (for)	Directional	Intransitive	external
[point/focus]	point (to)	Directional	Intransitive	external
	focus (on)	Directional	Intransitive	personal
Movement	go (to)	Directional	Intransitive	external

Ancillary & Non-Directional				
General	sense	not directional	Transitive	-
Physical Contact:	touch	not directional	Transitive	external
	feel	not directional	Transitive	personal
Molecular:	taste	not directional	Transitive	personal
	smell	not directional	Transitive	-